

Velocity

The speed at which the data is generated is also an important characteristic of Big Data. In today's world, massive amounts of data is generated real-time and hence needs to be worked upon real-time. Smart devices like sensors, meters, etc., generate a massive stream of information and hence need to be processed immediately.

Variety

Another important defining characteristic of a Big Data data platform is its ability to process data from a variety of sources and formats. This data can be structured or unstructured. An examples of structured data could be the numeric data stored in traditional databases while unstructured data could be anything from emails and videos to stock tickers and market transactions.

Actually, two more dimensions can be taken into consideration when talking about Big Data characteristics.



Along with the 3Vs, Veracity is also an important characteristic of Big Data

Variability

In a Big Data system, the flow of data is not always consistent; there could be peak periods and lean periods. For example, the flow of data from social media will change during different days of the week, time of the day and different events.

Veracity

There is also an unavoidable uncertainty of the data's quality in a Big Data system. The variation of the quality of data can also affect analysis.

Big Data Analytics (the 6Cs)

Simply collecting data and processing it will not help much, unless you can generate something useful from the processed data. The 6Cs of Big Data Analytics systems focus on **Connections, Cloud computing, Cyber**